Republic of the Philippines
Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
BANGSAMORO TRANSITION AUTHORITY PARLIAMENT
Bangsamoro Government Center, Cotabato City

THIRD REGULAR SESSION

PARLIAMENT RESOLUTION NO. 472

RESOLUTION REQUESTING THE PHILIPPINE NATIONAL POLICE REGIONAL OFFICE TO ESTABLISH A TOURIST-POLICE ASSISTANCE DESK IN MAJOR HOTELS AND INNS LOCATED IN POPULAR TOURIST DESTINATIONS IN THE BANGSAMORO REGION

WHEREAS, according to the Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA), the economy of the present Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) decelerated from five point eight percent (5.8%) in 2019 to negative one point nine percent (-1.9%) in 2020, and then strongly recovered with seven point five percent (7.5%) increase in 2021, the second-highest growth in the country;

WHEREAS, BARMM sees various opportunities to revitalize the region's economy due to its vast natural resources; natural landscapes and environment; historical landmarks; sceneries; wide range of flora and fauna; pristine white sandy beaches, crystalline spring waters, and towering waterfalls; and a variety of tourist attractions comparable to known tourist destinations in the country;

WHEREAS, the security of tourists is essential for any destination striving to increase its popularity among visitors. as it is one of the primary factors being considered by tourists who essentially seek enjoyment, relaxation, and relief from the stressful work environment or for some, work-related travel without having to worry about their personal safety and security;

WHEREAS, studies have shown that peace and order play a significant role in economic progress because investments will pour in considerably, and the potential market for tourism will potentially experience a surge;

WHEREAS, the Bangsamoro region has a long-standing history of the persistent presence of extremism and armed struggles, which have affected the tranquility and economic stability of the region for decades;

WHEREAS, countries all over the world have currently adopted the introduction of tourist police units to help protect tourists;

WHEREAS, Section 100 of Republic Act No. 9593, otherwise known as *"The Tourism Act of 2009"*, provides that the Philippine National Police (PNP) shall establish a Tourism Security Force to assist in maintaining peace and order within areas of high tourism traffic, ensuring the safety and security of tourists in the country;

WHEREAS, the regional crime index of BARMM was reduced by more than forty-two percent (42%) in 2021, with a total of seven hundred ten (710) reported crimes, compared to 2017 when one thousand six hundred seventy-six (1,676) index crimes in the BARMM, covering the 5 provinces and Cotabato City according to the PNP report;

WHEREAS, the increased number of the deployed police forces in various parts of the BARMM was considered as one of the major contributory factors towards achieving of the high crime solution efficiency rate;

WHEREAS, the influx of tourism in the region will significantly increase demand for hotels and guesthouse accommodations to house both local and international tourists and visitors arriving in the region for conventions, symposiums, seminars, business trips, or vacation;

WHEREAS, there are few related tourism enterprises operating in the region, which are concentrated in urban centers and growth areas, including hotels, inns, and resorts that are available for the accommodation of visiting tourists;

WHEREAS, the Bangsamoro Government recognizes the vital and indispensable role of the Philippine National Police as the primary law enforcement unit in helping to maintain peace and order in the community and as a significant stakeholder in the LGU's mission to build a progressive community of law-abiding citizenry;

WHEREAS, to ensure the personal safety and security of visiting tourists in any part of the region, there is a need to establish a Police Help Assistance desk to facilitate tourists' concerns in the event of threats to their life, security, and property;

WHEREAS, the neighboring city of Davao has been successful in implementing a similar project that helped the city to receive recognition as a tourist-friendly destination, significantly impacting tourism as an essential economic industry:

NOW, THEREFORE, be it

RESOLVED, as it is hereby resolved by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority Parliament, To request the Philippine National Police Regional Office to establish a tourist-police assistance desk in major hotels and inns located in popular tourist destinations in the Bangsamoro Region.

RESOLVED, FURTHER, To urge the PNP to provide the name of the Chief of Police of the City/Municipality and hotline numbers of the City/Municipal Police Station.

RESOLVED, FURTHERMORE, To forward this Resolution to the Philippine National Police Regional Office (PRO-BAR) and other concerned agencies, for information and consideration.

ADOPTED, *Muharram* 9, 1446/July 15, 2024.

Certified Correct:

PROF. RABY B. ANGKAL
Secretary-General

Attested:

ATTY. PANGALIAN M. BALINDONG
Speaker

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